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City Council
City of Haverhill
4 Summer St
Haverhill, MA 01830

Special Permit Application-27 Marshland Street, Haverhill, MA City Council Rules and Regulations for Special Permits Information Required

SPECIAL PERMIT PROJECT NARRATIVE

I. INTRODUCTION

This Project Narrative is submitted on behalf of the Applicant in support of a Special Permit application for the redevelopment of the property located at **27 Marshland Street, Haverhill, Massachusetts** (the "Property"). The Property is located within the **RH (High Density Residential) Zoning District** and is proposed to be redeveloped with a new **three-unit attached townhouse development** designed to provide high-quality owner-occupied residential housing while remaining compatible with the surrounding neighborhood. The application has been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the City of Haverhill Zoning Ordinance, including the Special Permit provisions contained in **Section 10.4**, the multifamily residential provisions applicable to the RH District, the dimensional regulations contained in **Section 4.0** and Appendix B, and the applicable performance standards contained in **Section 6.3**.

The Applicant respectfully requests approval of the proposed development based upon the plans and supporting documents submitted with this application, including the architectural drawings, certified survey, site development plans, drainage and utility information, and landscape plan. Together, these documents demonstrate that the proposed redevelopment satisfies the applicable zoning requirements while providing a substantial improvement to the Property and the surrounding neighborhood.

II. PROJECT OVERVIEW

The proposed development consists of the demolition of the existing single family improvements and construction of a **three-unit attached townhouse building** on a parcel containing approximately **13,000 square feet** located within the RH Zoning District. Each dwelling unit has been designed as an individual ownership residence consisting of approximately two stories above an attached two-car garage and includes three bedrooms, two and one-half bathrooms, private outdoor patio space, and independent utility services.

The overall development has been designed to maximize the efficient use of an infill residential parcel while preserving compatibility with adjacent residential properties. Architectural elevations utilize traditional residential building forms, pitched rooflines, quality exterior materials, and proportional façade articulation intended to complement the existing neighborhood character while providing an updated residential design consistent with modern construction standards.

The project provides:

- Three (3) attached townhouse dwelling units;
- Six (6) enclosed off-street parking spaces located within individual garages;
- Individual residential entrances for each dwelling;
- Private outdoor patio areas;
- Landscaped front, side, and rear yard areas;
- New municipal water and sewer connections;
- Stormwater management improvements;
- Code-compliant pedestrian and vehicular circulation; and
- Modern energy-efficient residential construction meeting current Massachusetts building and energy code requirements.

The proposed site layout has been developed to respect existing neighborhood development patterns while providing appropriate setbacks, landscaping, parking, access, and open space. The submitted plans demonstrate compliance with the applicable dimensional regulations governing the RH District, including lot coverage, setbacks, building height, and other site development standards.

III. PURPOSE OF THE APPLICATION

The purpose of this application is to obtain a Special Permit from the Haverhill Planning Board authorizing the proposed residential redevelopment in accordance with the provisions of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance. The Applicant respectfully submits that the proposed development satisfies the standards established for Special Permit approval because the project:

- Is consistent with the intent and purpose of the RH Residential District;
- Promotes high-quality residential redevelopment within an existing developed neighborhood;
- Provides safe and adequate vehicular and pedestrian access;
- Utilizes existing municipal infrastructure, including public water and sewer;
- Provides adequate off-street parking in accordance with the Ordinance;
- Incorporates professionally designed landscaping and site improvements;
- Meets applicable dimensional requirements and development standards; and
- Will not create adverse impacts upon adjoining properties or the surrounding neighborhood beyond those normally associated with residential development.

The Applicant further submits that the redevelopment advances the general purposes of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance by encouraging the appropriate use of land, promoting residential investment, improving neighborhood appearance, and increasing the City's housing inventory while maintaining compatibility with surrounding land uses.

IV. COMPLIANCE WITH THE SPECIAL PERMIT CRITERIA

Haverhill Zoning Ordinance – Section 10.4.2

Section 10.4 of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance authorizes the Special Permit Granting Authority ("SPGA") to issue Special Permits where the applicant demonstrates compliance with the applicable requirements of the Ordinance and where the Planning Board determines that the proposed development is consistent with the intent and purposes of the Zoning Ordinance and will not adversely affect the surrounding neighborhood. The Applicant respectfully submits that the proposed redevelopment satisfies these standards and supports the issuance of the requested Special Permit.

The following findings are respectfully submitted for the Planning Board's consideration.

A. Consistency with the Intent and Purpose of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance

The stated purpose of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance is to promote the public health, safety, convenience and general welfare of the City; encourage the most appropriate use of land; lessen congestion in the streets; conserve the value of land and buildings; and promote orderly growth consistent with the public interest.

The proposed redevelopment directly advances these objectives by replacing an aging single-family residence with a thoughtfully designed three-unit townhouse development that efficiently utilizes existing municipal infrastructure while remaining compatible with the established residential character of Marshland Street.

Rather than introducing a new commercial or incompatible use, the proposal continues the long-standing residential character of the neighborhood while improving the quality of the built environment through new construction meeting current Massachusetts Building Code, Energy Code and accessibility requirements.

Accordingly, the proposed development is consistent with both the intent and purpose of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance.

B. Compatibility with the Existing Neighborhood

One of the principal considerations of the Planning Board is whether the proposed development is compatible with surrounding properties and whether it will preserve the established character of the neighborhood.

The surrounding area is developed primarily with residential uses consisting of one-family, two-family and multifamily dwellings of varying ages and architectural styles. The proposed townhouse development represents a continuation of residential land use rather than an expansion into a different or more intensive land use category.

The proposed building has been designed with residential-scale architecture including:

- pitched roof forms;
- articulated building facades;
- individual dwelling entrances;
- attached garages;
- private outdoor living space;
- professionally designed landscaping; and
- materials commonly found in contemporary New England residential construction.

The overall massing of the building has been intentionally organized to reduce visual impacts while maintaining an attractive streetscape. The building height remains below the maximum height permitted within the RH District, and the submitted elevations demonstrate a residential appearance that is consistent with surrounding development.

For these reasons, the Applicant respectfully submits that the project is compatible with the surrounding neighborhood and will enhance the overall appearance of Marshland Street.

C. Protection of Public Health, Safety and Welfare

The proposed redevelopment has been designed to protect the public health, safety and general welfare through compliance with applicable zoning, building, fire protection and utility requirements.

The project will utilize existing municipal water and sanitary sewer systems and will be constructed in accordance with the Massachusetts State Building Code, Massachusetts Fire Code and applicable municipal engineering standards.

Emergency vehicle access has been maintained through direct driveway access and adequate site circulation.

Each dwelling unit includes enclosed parking, code-compliant means of egress and independent utility services.

The redevelopment eliminates an older residential structure and replaces it with modern energy-efficient construction designed in accordance with the current Massachusetts Stretch Energy Code, thereby improving both life safety and long-term building performance.

Accordingly, the proposed development promotes public health, safety and welfare.

D. Traffic, Access and Circulation

The proposed development is not anticipated to generate traffic volumes beyond those reasonably associated with residential townhouse development.

Vehicular access has been designed to provide safe ingress and egress while minimizing conflicts with pedestrian circulation.

Each dwelling unit is provided with an individual driveway and attached two-car garage, resulting in a total of six enclosed off-street parking spaces.

The parking layout complies with the intent of the City's off-street parking regulations and substantially reduces the likelihood of on-street parking impacts upon neighboring properties. Parking is provided on-site in accordance with Section 6.1 of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance.

Because all required parking is accommodated on-site, the development is not expected to create adverse traffic conditions or parking deficiencies within the neighborhood.

E. Municipal Services and Utilities

The Property is served by existing municipal infrastructure including public water, sanitary sewer, electric and other public utilities.

The proposed redevelopment does not require expansion of municipal utility systems beyond ordinary service connections associated with residential development.

By utilizing existing public infrastructure, the project represents an efficient use of municipal resources while avoiding unnecessary extension of public facilities.

The Applicant has coordinated utility connections through the submitted engineering and site development plans, and all work will be completed in accordance with applicable City standards.

F. Compliance with Dimensional Regulations

The submitted site plans and certified survey demonstrate that the proposed redevelopment has been designed in accordance with the applicable dimensional regulations governing development within the RH Zoning District.

The proposed building footprint, setbacks, lot coverage and overall building configuration have been carefully coordinated to satisfy the dimensional requirements established within Appendix B of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance.

The proposed building footprint is approximately **3,281 square feet**, representing approximately **25 percent lot coverage**, consistent with the dimensional standards applicable to the RH District. Building height remains below the maximum height permitted by the Ordinance.

Accordingly, the Applicant submits that the project satisfies the applicable dimensional requirements and promotes orderly site development consistent with the Ordinance.

V. COMPLIANCE WITH APPLICABLE DEVELOPMENT STANDARDS

Haverhill Zoning Ordinance – Section 6.3

Although the proposed development is a residential project, the Applicant has designed the site in accordance with the applicable development standards contained within the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance. The project has been planned to ensure compatibility with surrounding residential properties while minimizing impacts upon adjoining landowners and public infrastructure. The submitted architectural, site, landscape and survey plans demonstrate that the development has been designed in accordance with accepted planning and engineering practices.

A. Site Planning and Building Layout

The proposed townhouse building has been carefully positioned on the Property to provide an efficient and orderly site layout while maintaining the required building setbacks, appropriate separation from adjoining properties, and functional vehicular circulation.

Unlike many infill developments that maximize building footprint at the expense of open space, this proposal intentionally preserves substantial landscaped and permeable areas surrounding the building. The placement of the structure also creates clearly defined front, side and rear yard areas while maintaining a residential streetscape consistent with surrounding development.

The site layout provides logical pedestrian access from Marshland Street to each dwelling unit and maintains independent vehicular access to each garage through individual driveway entrances.

The proposed building orientation, massing and setbacks have been selected to minimize visual impacts upon adjoining residential properties while preserving privacy and maintaining appropriate spatial relationships throughout the neighborhood.

B. Landscaping and Open Space

The Applicant has prepared and submitted a comprehensive Landscape Plan as part of this application. The proposed landscaping substantially enhances the Property through new lawn areas, foundation plantings and landscape improvements that contribute to the overall visual character of the development.

The Landscape Plan has been prepared to soften the visual appearance of the building, improve the streetscape, define outdoor spaces and provide an attractive transition between the proposed development and neighboring residential properties.

The redevelopment significantly increases the quality of the site by replacing an aging residential structure with professionally designed landscaping integrated into the overall site design.

In addition to improving aesthetics, the landscaped areas contribute to stormwater infiltration, reduction of impervious surface impacts and enhancement of neighborhood appearance.

The Applicant respectfully submits that the proposed landscaping satisfies the intent of the City's landscaping standards and provides a substantial public benefit beyond the existing site conditions.

C. Stormwater Management

Stormwater management has been incorporated into the design of the project through the site grading and drainage improvements shown on the submitted plans.

The proposed redevelopment replaces an older developed parcel with a professionally engineered drainage system designed to manage runoff in accordance with applicable engineering practices and municipal requirements.

The combination of landscaped open space, controlled site grading and engineered drainage improvements minimizes the potential for adverse impacts upon neighboring properties while improving the long-term functionality of the Property.

All drainage improvements will be constructed in accordance with applicable City requirements and any conditions imposed by the Planning Board or City Engineer during the permitting process.

Accordingly, the Applicant submits that the proposed redevelopment satisfies the intent of the City's stormwater management standards.

D. Pedestrian and Vehicular Circulation

Safe pedestrian and vehicular circulation has been a primary consideration in the design of the proposed development.

Each townhouse unit is served by an individual driveway leading directly to an enclosed two-car garage, thereby eliminating the need for large shared parking fields or complicated internal circulation patterns.

Pedestrian access has been designed to provide safe and convenient access from the public sidewalk to each dwelling entrance without conflict with vehicular movement.

The proposed circulation pattern minimizes unnecessary vehicle maneuvering and provides efficient access for residents, visitors and emergency responders.

Because all required parking is accommodated on-site, the project is not expected to create parking overflow or circulation issues on Marshland Street.

The Applicant therefore submits that the proposed circulation system promotes public safety while satisfying the intent of the City's access and circulation standards.

E. Architectural Design and Neighborhood Character

The architectural design has been developed with the objective of creating an attractive residential building that complements the surrounding neighborhood while incorporating contemporary construction techniques and materials.

Rather than introducing a commercial or institutional building form, the proposed development utilizes residential rooflines, articulated façades, individual unit entrances, attached garages and proportional architectural elements that reflect the scale and character of nearby residential development.

The building elevations incorporate varied façade treatments and architectural detailing that reduce the apparent mass of the structure and create the appearance of individual townhouse residences rather than a single monolithic building.

The proposed design represents a substantial visual improvement over the existing conditions and contributes positively to the continued revitalization of the surrounding neighborhood.

F. Utilities and Municipal Infrastructure

The Property is served by existing municipal water, sanitary sewer and public utility infrastructure.

The proposed development has been designed to utilize these existing public services without requiring expansion of municipal infrastructure beyond customary service connections.

Utility improvements associated with the project will be completed in accordance with City standards and coordinated with the appropriate municipal departments and utility providers.

Because the redevelopment occurs within an established residential neighborhood already served by municipal infrastructure, the project represents an efficient use of existing public facilities while avoiding unnecessary public expenditures.

Accordingly, the Applicant submits that the proposed development is consistent with the utility and infrastructure objectives of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance.

G. Environmental and Community Benefits

The proposed redevelopment provides numerous long-term benefits to both the immediate neighborhood and the City of Haverhill.

These benefits include:

- Replacement of an aging residential structure with high-quality new construction;
- Increased investment in an established residential neighborhood;
- Improved landscaping and site appearance;
- Modern energy-efficient construction;
- Enhanced stormwater management;
- Efficient use of existing municipal infrastructure;
- Additional homeownership opportunities within the RH Zoning District; and
- Increased property tax value through reinvestment in the Property.

The Applicant respectfully submits that these improvements further the public purposes of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance by promoting appropriate residential development while preserving neighborhood character and protecting the public health, safety and welfare.

VI. PROPOSED FINDINGS OF FACT AND BASIS FOR APPROVAL

The Applicant respectfully submits that the record, including the plans, reports, and supporting materials submitted with this application, provides a sufficient factual basis for the Planning Board to make the findings required for issuance of the requested Special Permit pursuant to the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance.

Based upon the materials submitted, the Applicant respectfully requests that the Planning Board find as follows:

Finding No. 1 – Consistency with the Purpose of the Zoning Ordinance

The proposed redevelopment is consistent with the purposes of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance by promoting the appropriate use of land, encouraging reinvestment within an established residential neighborhood, protecting the public health and safety, and improving the quality of the built environment through well-designed residential development.

Finding No. 2 – Appropriate Residential Development

The proposed three-unit townhouse development represents an appropriate residential use of the Property within the RH Zoning District and is compatible with surrounding residential land uses.

The proposal continues the residential character of the neighborhood while replacing an aging structure with new construction designed in accordance with current building, life safety and energy code requirements.

Finding No. 3 – Compliance with Applicable Zoning Requirements

The submitted plans demonstrate compliance with the applicable dimensional standards, parking requirements, site design criteria and development standards governing the proposed use.

The Applicant has submitted architectural plans, certified survey information, site development plans and landscape plans demonstrating that the proposed development has been designed in accordance with the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance and applicable municipal requirements.

Finding No. 4 – Adequate Access and Parking

Safe vehicular and pedestrian access has been incorporated into the proposed development.

Each dwelling unit is served by an individual driveway and attached two-car garage providing six enclosed off-street parking spaces. The proposed circulation system minimizes conflicts between pedestrians and vehicles while reducing the demand for on-street parking within the surrounding neighborhood.

The Planning Board may therefore reasonably conclude that the proposed development provides adequate parking and circulation consistent with the objectives of the Ordinance.

Finding No. 5 – Municipal Services

The Property is served by existing municipal water, sanitary sewer and other public utilities.

No extraordinary demand upon municipal infrastructure is anticipated as a result of the proposed residential redevelopment.

The proposed project therefore represents an efficient use of existing public infrastructure while supporting continued investment within an established residential area.

Finding No. 6 – Landscaping and Site Improvements

The Applicant has submitted a professional Landscape Plan providing foundation plantings, lawn areas and site improvements intended to enhance the appearance of the Property and improve compatibility with adjoining residential properties.

The proposed landscaping contributes positively to neighborhood character while assisting with stormwater management and the overall visual quality of the development.

Finding No. 7 – Neighborhood Character

The scale, massing, architectural design and residential character of the proposed townhouse development are compatible with surrounding residential properties.

The building has been designed to function as an attractive residential development that complements existing neighborhood development patterns while modernizing the Property and increasing the quality of housing available within the City.

The Planning Board may reasonably conclude that the proposed development will not create adverse visual impacts upon the surrounding neighborhood.

Finding No. 8 – Public Benefit

The proposed redevelopment provides substantial public benefits including:

- Elimination of an aging residential structure.
- Construction of three high-quality residential ownership units.
- Increased investment within an established neighborhood.
- Improved landscaping and site aesthetics.
- Modern energy-efficient construction.
- Efficient use of existing municipal infrastructure.
- Increased local property tax value.
- Expansion of Haverhill's owner-occupied housing opportunities.

Collectively, these improvements advance the planning objectives of the City while providing long-term benefits to both the neighborhood and the community as a whole.

VII. CONCLUSION

For the reasons set forth herein, and based upon the submitted architectural plans, site plans, certified survey, landscape plans, supporting reports and other application materials, the Applicant respectfully submits that the proposed redevelopment satisfies the applicable standards for issuance of a Special Permit under the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance.

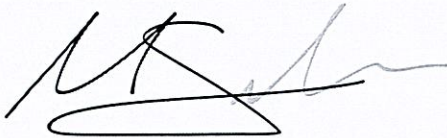
The proposed three-unit townhouse development represents an appropriate and thoughtful reinvestment in an established residential neighborhood. The project has been designed to comply with the applicable dimensional requirements, parking standards, site development requirements and performance standards of the Ordinance while preserving neighborhood character, promoting high-quality residential development and protecting the public health, safety and welfare.

The Applicant respectfully requests that the Planning Board determine that the application satisfies the requirements of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance, approve the requested Special Permit, and authorize the proposed redevelopment subject to such reasonable conditions as the Planning Board deems appropriate.

Respectfully submitted,

Applicant:

Matt Silva

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'MS', with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Item	Proposed
Zoning District	RH
Lot Area	13,145 SF (or final survey value)
Proposed Use	Three Attached Townhouses
Building Footprint	3,281 SF
Building Coverage	25.0%
Stories	2
Building Height	27.8 FT
Bedrooms	3 per unit (9 total)
Bathrooms	2.5 per unit
Parking	6 enclosed garage spaces
Water	Municipal
Sewer	Municipal
Landscape Plan	Submitted
Survey	Certified Survey Submitted